

built to work in tandem with GIMP. The apps are regularly updated with new camera formats and is a bit more challenging when editing RAW image files. Essentially speaking GIMP is a good place for anyone interested in getting involved with photo editing for free while its a good alternative for people who don't want to pay for a Photoshop like software either. GIMP isn't Photoshop with a makeover, it's a unique and distinctly different software with its own strengths and weaknesses that need to be adjusted in your workflow. But as far as results go, GIMP can butt heads with Photoshop and hold its own.

Paint.NET

Get it at: <http://www.getpaint.net/download.html>

Run it on: Windows *with* .NET Framework 4.5

Don't worry, this isn't a new version of MS Paint that you played with as a kid. Another product of a college project (funded by Microsoft) that's found a life of its own in the open source community, Paint.NET employs *the* .NET Framework to give users a surprising result in terms of efficiency and user

experience. Starting with a blank canvas and four toolboxes docked to the corners of the screen you can begin exploring the application which is more spacious than GIMP. The application needs exploration to be functional since it doesn't come with a guide or wizard to point you in the right direction. Thank-



fully the highly intuitive and simple layout doesn't take much time to learn and soon enough you're on your way to editing images using its wide assortments of effects, adjustments and plug-ins. The tabbed thumbnail option displays upto 9 images at a time with scrolling options for more. Like professional editing tools it comes with a range of brushes for drawing, magic wand options, cloning and everything else you'd expect. Its easier to learn than GIMP, if not as powerful, but can accomplish nearly as much. 